PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
Board of Education
Tuesday, April 29, 2025

Public Comment and Work Session on the 2025-26 Proposed Budget

Informal Meeting Minutes

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Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Public Comment and Work Session on the 2025-26 Proposed Budget of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held at Grant High School, 2245 NE 36th Ave., Portland, OR 97212 and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Director Julia Brim-Edwards: Present; Director Michelle DePass: Present; Director Herman Greene: Present; Director Gary Hollands: Present; Director Christy Splitt: Present; Director Patte Sullivan: Present; Director Edward Wang: Present; Student Representative JJ Kunsevi: Present

Call to Order

Board Chair Eddie Wang called the meeting to order and the Board convened as the budget committee at 6:09 pm.

Public Comment on the Proposed 2025-26 Budget

Staff: Michelle Morrison – Chief Financial Officer

Staff provided an overview of the 2025-26 budget situation.

The Budget Committee heard public comment.

- Representative Daniel Nguyen: In support of continued funding of the Dual Language Program.
- Representative Thuy Tran: In support of investing in dual language programs.
- Angela Bonilla, PAT President: Concerns about the budget, with a request to reinstate teachers with the withheld 25% of Title funds.
- Nicci Kaufman: Opposed to cuts to Portland Federation of School Professionals (PFSP) employees, many of whom provide federally mandate roles.
- Anne Cherry: The Architects and management costs in the bond are too high, keep looking at cost cuts in modernizations.
- Bohdan Koshurba: Importance of the language access support in schools.
- Catherine Tucker: Opposed to cuts to enrichment teachers and school counselors.
- Emma Pattee: Seismic upgrades are needed in schools.
- Allison Taylor: Importance of dual language programs.
- John Dwyer: Allocate bond fund to seismic improvements.
- Breanna Gervais: The Indian Education program needs funding and to be reflected in the budget.
- Jorge Sanchez Bautista: In support of language access services.
- Mary Watkins: Allocate funds to paraeducator positions.
- Per Olstad: Allocate bond funds to seismic upgrades.
- Raisa Puchalski: Opposed to cuts in positions for teachers, language access services, and career coordinators.
- Virginia La Forte: The importance of College and Career Coordinators.
- Bruce Morrison: Fund Indian Education.
- Sakura Hamada: The importance of language access and school-based staff.
- Tori Padellford: Call a state of emergency, Salem needs to provide more funding for schools.
- Aryah Harbauer: Opposed to cuts in the dance program at Ockley Green Middle School.
- Maya Pueo Von Geldern: Oregon doesn't fund to Quality Education Model (QEM), urged everyone to go lobby in Salem.
- Hung Freel: In support of PPS Vietnamese interpreters for students and families.
- David Machado: Fund Racial Equity and Social Justice (RESJ) programs.
- Qiao Li: Do not cut staffing for PPS Language Access services.
- Zoya Syrits: The importance of language access services in immersion programs.
- Natalia Gunther: The importance of language access services.
- Mariah Bennett-Gillard: Don't cut records management staffing by 25%.
- Joe Rose: The Board needs to do more to get the bond passed, value teachers, and cut from the top.
- Simone Crowe: Prioritize small class sizes, language access support and seismic upgrades.
- Ginger Huizar: Special education needs better staffing to meet mandatory services.

- Nicole Safranek: The importance of language access staff.
- David Roberts: Allocate funds for seismic improvements in PPS Buildings.
- Reggie Nock: The importance of language access services.
- Yasmin Lorrea: Allocate funds for maintenance in older buildings.
- Charlotte (last name not provided): Cut from the top and continue to reaffirm centering diversity and equity.
- Aryn Frazier: Maintain funding for RESJ partners; spend already allocated bond funds on a property for the Center for Black Student Excellence (CBSE), and dedicate one full staff member to the CBSE.

2025-26 Proposed Budget Work Session

Time: 7:58 pm

Staff: Candice Grose – Chief of Communications; Deborah Kauforey – Chief of Staff; Michelle Morrison – Chief of Finance

Board members asked questions and provided comments on the proposed 2025-26 budget, including clarification and questions on potential reductions to the language access program, the use of reserves, and strategies for state advocacy—such as the potential of calling a state of emergency on school funding. Discussion also included upcoming seismic improvement needs, how they relate to the 2025 bond scope, and questions around PERS cost increases and the use of the PERS reserve fund. Board members requested additional information on duplicated district services, vendor roles, and more specific details on funding allocations.

Adjourn

The meeting of the Budget Committee was adjourned at 9:09 pm by Board Chair Eddie Wang.